

# Schema Support for Educators



## Try This:

Snatching and shoving can feel so exhausting during a busy floor shift. Take a deep breath and look for the physical need driving their hands.

Notice if the child is seeking to move heavy items, launch objects, or connect materials together.

**Why this happens:** When children snatch, their body is experiencing a powerful sensory drive to move or touch something before their developing brain can pause to ask.

What physical motor urge was driving the child when they reached out?

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**Rung 1 of 10**  
**Identify the Urge**

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**Why this happens:** Carrying heavy items satisfies a strong physical need to transport objects while naturally slowing their steps and requiring them to pay attention to a partner body.

## Try This:

Arguments over who gets to carry the 'best' toys can feel constant. Give two children a heavy wooden crate with handles on both sides to carry across the garden together.

How did the children adjust their steps to keep the crate level together?

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**Rung 2 of 10**  
**Tandem Crate Carry**

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**Why this happens:** Watching a partner catch the rolling ball links physical movement directly to another person, helping children see how their actions affect a friend.

## Try This:

Set up long bamboo gutters on a gentle slope in the garden. Ask one child to lift the top end of the gutter high while their partner places the wooden ball and catches it in a wicker basket at the bottom.

How did the children shift their bodies to keep the ball rolling smoothly together?

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**Rung 3 of 10**  
**Gutter Ball Roll**

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**Why this happens:** High energy throwing or rolling urges feel deeply satisfying for a developing body, and sharing a target basket turns competing into a fun team goal.

## Try This:

Create a partner target game on the grass. Ask one child to gently roll soft beanbags or balls down a gentle garden slope while their partner holds a wide basket low on the ground to catch them together.

How did the children shift their focus from competing alone to scoring points together?

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**Rung 4 of 10**  
**Partner Basket Catch**

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**Why this happens:** Pushing heavy objects with open palms provides deep muscle feedback that calms the body while requiring two children to match their physical strength together.

## Try This:

Place a heavy wooden cable drum or barrel on the grass and ask two children to stand side by side. Encourage them to press their palms against the wood and push together to roll it toward the tree.

What did you notice about their body effort as they pushed the barrel together?

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**Rung 5 of 10**  
**Dual Barrel Roll**

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**Why this happens:** Building enclosed spaces satisfies a deep sensory need to create safe boundaries, while taking physical turns with heavy blocks helps regulate impulsive energy.

## Try This:

Invite two children to build a garden fort wall together. Create a simple rhythm where each child takes turns placing one hollow wooden block on the wall until it grows tall.

How did taking turns with heavy wooden blocks help calm their urgency to build?

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**Rung 6 of 10**  
**Co Built Wall**

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**Why this happens:** Connecting physical track pieces forces children to slow down their movements and look at where their friend is building before taking their own turn.

## Try This:

Place wooden tracks near the sandpit or garden deck and ask two children to build together. Create a simple rule where every new piece must connect directly to their partner piece before driving the trucks.

Did the children look at where their partner placed a piece before adding their own?

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**Rung 7 of 10**  
**Track Piece Connect**

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**Why this happens:** Children often miss physical cues from peers, so hearing adult commentary helps them tune into how others feel during shared play.

## Try This:

Describe a friend physical efforts out loud while they work together. Mention how hard their partner is pulling the rope or how steady their hands are holding the board.

What body signal did you point out to help them notice their partner?

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**Rung 8 of 10**  
**Partner Body Words**

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**Why this happens:** High speed movement keeps the nervous system in a quick reactive state, whereas moving slowly together helps activate the thinking part of the brain and keeps bodies calm.

## Try This:

Turn the rush into a slow motion team challenge. Invite two children to walk like giant slow astronauts across the grass while holding onto opposite ends of a smooth wooden log together.

How did slowing down their body movements change their energy and teamwork?

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**Rung 9 of 10**  
**Slow Motion Pacing**

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**Why this happens:** Carefully placing natural treasures gives small hands delicate motor work, which naturally slows their breathing and builds calm focus with a friend.

## Try This:

Invite two children to sit together near the sandpit with a shared basket of collected leaves, flower petals, and smooth stones. Encourage them to place the items side by side to build a quiet circular pattern on a low timber deck together.

How did sitting side by side and placing natural items help ground their body energy?

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**Rung 10 of 10**  
**Gentle Nature Pattern**